Si Huang

Ph.D. Candidate in Economics, Queen's University
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Education

Queen's University, Ph.D. in Economics — Expected June 2027
Supervisors: Prof. Robert Clark, Prof. Nahim Zahur, Prof. James MacKinnon
University of Toronto, M.A. in Economics — June 2021
University of Waterloo, B.A. (Honours) in Economics — June 2020

Research Interests

Empirical Industrial Organization, Competition Policy, Empirical Microeconomics

Job Market Paper

Compatibility in Tied-Goods Markets: Evidence from Razors and Blades [link]
Available on November 14, pending Nielsen approval.

Policy Papers

Beyond Leniency: Using Procurement Data to Strengthen Bid-Rigging Enforcement in Canada [link]
JDI Policy Insights, No. 26-1025, 2026

Working Papers

An Investigation into the Bidding Process for WIC Infant Formula Contracts [link]
Joint with Rob Clark and David Davis

Abstract: Motivated by the FTC's ongoing investigation, this paper examines whether infant formula manufacturers colluded in bidding for WIC infant formula contracts. Using auction data from 2003 to 2021, we compare bidders' behavior during a competitive benchmark period (2003–2013) with that observed in the alleged collusive period (2016–2021). Descriptive patterns reveal that participation declined in the alleged period—consistent with reduced competition—yet when Abbott and MJ met head-to-head, winning bids fell even more sharply. Incumbents were more likely to retain contracts, but only by bidding more aggressively, not through rivals' restraint. To formally test for collusion, we implement state-of-the-art collusion screens that target two behaviors central to the FTC's allegation: bid rotation and cover bidding. These include tests from Kawai et al. (2023), Porter and Zona (1993), Huber and Imhof (2019) and Clark et al. (2025). Across these methods, we find little evidence of systematic bid rigging in WIC auctions during the alleged period.

Presented at: Canadian Economics Association Annual Meetings (May 2025); Agricultural & Applied Economics Association Annual Meeting (July 2025)

Work in Progress

Screens for Collusion: How Much Should We Trust Them?

Abstract: Competition authorities around the world rely on statistical screens to detect potential bid rigging and identify cases that warrant further investigation. Although many screens have been proposed in the literature, little is known about their relative effectiveness. This paper addresses this gap by simulating competitive and collusive bidding data using a structural auction model, applying widely used screens, and systematically comparing their performance across different collusive scenarios.

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant, Queen's University — Sept 2021 – Present

- PhD-level: ECON 816 – Advanced Macroeconomic Theory I (Fall 2022, Fall 2023, Fall 2024); ECON 817 – Advanced Macroeconomic Theory II (Winter 2023, Winter 2024, Winter 2025)
- Undergraduate: ECON 111 – Introductory Microeconomics (Summer 2025, Summer 2026); ECON 223 –

Macroeconomic Policy (Summer 2023, Summer 2024); ECON 256 – Math for Economics and Business (Winter 2026); ECON 310 – Microeconomic Theory II (Winter 2022); ECON 352 – Applied Econometrics (Fall 2026); ECON 361 – Income Distribution and Inequalities (Fall 2021); ECON 435/835 – Development Economics (Fall 2025)

Teaching Assistant, University of Toronto Sept 2020 – Apr 2021

- ECO 220 - Introduction to Data Analysis and Applied Econometrics (Fall/Winter 2020/2021)

Awards and Fellowships

- John Deutsch Institute Fellowship in Economic Policy (2025–2026), Queen's University
- W Edmund Clark Scholarship (2024–2025), Queen's University
- Christine Morin Fellowship (2021–2025), Queen's University
- QED Department Award (2021–2025), Queen's University
- Queen's Graduate Award (2023), Queen's University
- Justice D. Henry Award (2023), Queen's University
- Departmental Award for Distinguished Academic Achievement, University of Waterloo (2020) — Awarded to the top graduating student.
- Faculty of Arts Upper-Year Scholarship (2020), University of Waterloo

Technical Skills

Programming: R, Stata, MATLAB, Python
Languages: English, Chinese, Dutch (basic)

Service and Outreach

- Graduate Mentor, Faculty of Arts and Science, Queen's University (Sept 2024 – Oct 2026)
  - Advised prospective graduate students on graduate study and student life at Queen's.
- Research Consultant, PhD-Community Initiative, in partnership with Kingston Economic Development Corporation (KEDC), Queen's University (Sept 2024 – May 2025)
  - Designed an entrepreneurship program for older adults for KEDC as part of an interdisciplinary team of Ph.D. students

References

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